

In candor, these words serve to remind me that my own pride too often peeps out and shows itself, and that my own humility could use a little more development.

Franklin's mind is indeed the eighteenth-century mind at work—a model for our times. It is a contrast that reminds us that we have steeped ourselves quite enough in twenty-first-century values, driven largely by self-interest, and not nearly enough in the values of the eighteenth century, when the impartial spectator was our guide and a sense of common purpose pervaded our society.